Life Cycles

A life cycle shows the stages a living thing goes through as it grows and change s.

Butterfly (monarch): 1 egg - laid on a swan plant leaf. 2 caterpillar (larva) - eats lots of leaves and grows. 3 chrysalis (pupa) - the caterpillar hangs still while its body changes inside. 4 adult butterfly - comes out, dries its wings an d flies. The adult lays eggs and the cycle begins again. This is a complete meta morphosis with four stages.

Frog: 1 eggs (frogspawn) are laid in water. 2 tadpoles hatch and live in the wat er with a tail and gills. 3 the tadpole grows back legs, then front legs - a fro glet. 4 the tail shrinks and an adult frog lives on land and in water.

Plant: 1 a seed. 2 germination, when the seed starts to grow with water and warm th. 3 a seedling with first leaves. 4 an adult plant. 5 flowers, which make new seeds so the cycle repeats.

Humans have a life cycle too: baby, child, teenager, adult, older adult.

Not every animal changes shape. A baby chick looks like a small hen, but a cater pillar does not look like a butterfly.